

GLOSSARY

ACHERON RIVER river in the underworld. Souls can only cross it in the boat of the ferryman, Charon

AMAZONS group of warrior women who live apart from the rest of society

AMBROSIA food of the gods that can make mortals immortal if they eat it

APHRODITE goddess of love and beauty and one of the 12 Olympians

APOLLO god of music and one of the 12 Olympians

ARES god of war and one of the 12 Olympians

ARTEMIS goddess of hunting and one of the 12 Olympians

ASPHODEL FIELDS part of the underworld covered in fields of white asphodel flowers

ATHENA goddess of war and wisdom and one of the 12 Olympians

CENTAUR creature with the head and torso of a man and the body of a horse

CERBERUS Hades' pet dog who has three heads and guards the gates to the underworld

CHARIOT small roofless carriage pulled by horses

CHIMAERA monster that looks like a lion, but with a dragon's head for a tail and a fire-breathing goat's head poking out of its back

CITY-STATE independent city, and sometimes the surrounding area, that rules itself and has its own king or government

CONSTELLATION collection of stars in the sky that make a shape

CYCLOPS one-eyed giant. Three brother Cyclopes make Zeus's thunderbolts

DEMETER goddess of the harvest and one of the 12 Olympians

DIONYSUS god of wine, parties, and theater. He is sometimes counted as one of the 12 Olympians

ELYSIUM island in the underworld reserved for people the gods want to honor

EPIC POEM long poem that tells a story, usually a myth, such as *The Iliad*, which is about the Trojan War

FATES three goddesses who decide the lifespan of mortals

FURIES three goddesses who punish wrongdoers

GAIA goddess of the Earth. She was the first god to appear

GAMES athletic event held throughout ancient Greece in honor of the gods. Events include running and chariot racing

GOD powerful immortal being. Each god is in charge of a different part of the world and may even be that part of the world—for example, the goddess Gaia is also the Earth

GORGON monstrous woman with snakes for hair who can turn mortals to stone by looking at them

HADES god of the underworld who rules over the souls of the dead. He is sometimes counted as one of the 12 Olympians

HARPY creature that is half-bird, half-woman

HECATONCHEIRES giants with 50 heads and 100 arms each

HEPHAESTUS god of smiths and volcanoes and one of the 12 Olympians

HERA goddess of marriage and queen of the gods. She is married to Zeus

HERMES messenger god and one of the 12 Olympians

HESTIA goddess of the hearth and one of the 12 Olympians